

Topic 4.1

4.1: Comments on Reading Assignments for Module 3

Learning to use dynamic allocation and deallocation properly is one of the most important aspects of learning C++. While the functions `malloc` and `free` we know from C are still available, we have better tools in C++.

C++ provides an operator `new`. This is an operator, not a function, hence the compiler performs many of the computations we had to perform ourselves in C. When the object being allocated is an instance of a class, after the memory is allocated the constructor for the object is invoked.

The `delete` operator is the way we dispose of dynamically allocated objects. When the object being disposed of is an instance of a class, the destructor is first called, then the memory is deallocated.

Don't get too bogged down in the linked list and subsequent examples in Chapter 20. The text author jumped into all aspects of dynamic memory with both feet. We'll take it a bit slower and revisit linked lists later.

Topic 4.2 (<https://onlinelearning.berkeley.edu/courses/2291660/pages/topic-4-dot-2>)